

Captain Ben and the kindness treasure

Pirate story • 3-4 years old



Captain Ben wakes on the deck of his small ship. The sun is warm. The sea is blue. He pulls on his hat and smiles. His parrot Pip hops on his shoulder. « **Good day, Captain!** » squawks Pip.

The crew is small and kind. There is Mina, who reads maps. There is Tom, who steers the wheel. There is Momo, a little cat who likes to nap. They laugh together. They sing a bright song as the ship sails.

Captain Ben has a wooden leg and a gentle laugh. He loves the sea. He loves islands with tall palm trees and sandy beaches. He loves finding small treasures that make him happy. Today he looks at a paper map. The map has a big red X on a tiny island. « **Treasure!** » says Mina softly.

« **Let us go,** » says Captain Ben. He taps his hat. Pip flaps his wings. The crew cheers. The ship cuts through the friendly waves.

They sail past dolphins that clap with their fins. They see a school of bright fish. The wind smells of salt and flowers. Captain Ben points with his old spyglass. « **Land ahead!** » he says.

The island is small and green. Birds sing in the trees. The shore glitters with shells. The crew steps onto the sand. Momo sniffs the air and purrs. They hold hands and bounce with joy.

The map shows a palm tree with a heart carved in it. « **This way,** » says Mina. They walk under big leaves. Little crabs scuttle and wave their claws. The ground is soft. Captain Ben hums a tune.

They find the palm tree. It has a small door at the base. « **A tiny house,** » says Tom. The door creaks open. Inside there is a box. It is tied with a ribbon. Captain Ben opens the box with gentle hands.

Inside are shiny stones, but not gold. There are colorful buttons, a small mirror, and a paper boat. Captain Ben laughs. « **This is a kindness treasure,** » he says. He lifts a smooth stone and hears a quiet chime. Each thing makes a happy

sound.

They play with the treasures. Mina ties a button on her hat. Tom sees his face in the mirror and makes a funny face. Pip tries to wear the paper boat on his head. They giggle. The little treasures make them warm inside.

« **Wait,** » says Mina. « **The map has another mark.** » She points to a curvy path. Captain Ben nods. « **Adventure calls!** » he says. They follow the path into the trees.

The trees grow thicker. The leaves make soft music. They come to a small lagoon. The water is calm and clear. Tiny fish swim like silver stars. In the middle of the lagoon is a shiny shell. It is bigger than a bowl.

Captain Ben walks on stepping stones. He reaches the shell. It is warm. When he opens it, a little light floats up. The light giggles like a bell. « **Hello,** » it says in a tiny voice. The crew listens. The light says, « **I guard happy wishes. Share a wish, and it will glow.** »

Captain Ben closes his eyes. He thinks of the crew, the sea, and the little treasures. He makes a small wish. He wishes for more days like today. The light glows bright. It swirls around the crew. Everyone feels cozy and glad.

They sail back to the ship with the treasures and the light. The wind picks up and the sky fills with soft clouds. « **A little storm,** » says Tom. The crew feels a tiny worry. Captain Ben pats the wheel. « **We will be brave,** » he says. His voice is calm and gentle.

The rain taps the deck like tiny drums. The sails flap. Pip sings a silly song. The crew works together. Mina tucks the map in a safe place. Tom holds the wheel steady. Captain Ben ties a rope and checks the sails. Momo finds a dry spot and curls up. The storm is noisy but not scary. The crew follows Captain Ben's calm ways. They sing and hum and the rain becomes a lullaby.

When the rain stops, a rainbow stretches over the sea. The ship glows with

colors. « **Look!** » says Mina. They all clap. The light from the lagoon dances on the water. It sparkles like tiny stars.

At sunset they reach home harbor. Small houses smile by the shore. Friends wave from the quay. Captain Ben steps onto the dock with Pip on his shoulder. He carries the box of treasures. The light twinkles and hops into Pip's wing and then hides like a friend.

They share the small treasures with people in the town. They give shiny stones to children. They show the mirror to a grandma who laughs. Tom gives the paper boat to a little boy. Mina gives a button to a baker. Everyone feels the warm glow of the wish.

That night, Captain Ben sits by the harbor. The moon floats on the sea. He thinks of the day. He feels brave and happy. He looks at his crew and smiles. « **Good work,** » he says softly.

Pip tucks his head under his wing. Momo sleeps on a warm sack. The crew dreams of waves, songs, and kind treasures. Captain Ben closes his eyes. He hears the sea breathe. He hears a soft chime from the little stone. He smiles.

The treasure was not just gold. It was laughter, help, and being together. Captain Ben knows there will be more islands and more gentle adventures. For now, he is home. The harbor lamp glows. The night is kind and quiet. Everyone sleeps safe and warm.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) What is the name of the captain?

- Captain Jack
- Captain Ben
- Captain Tom
- Captain Mina

2) Who is the parrot?

- Pip
- Momo
- Tom
- Ben

3) What do they find in the treasure box?

- Gold coins
- Shiny stones
- Old maps
- Toys

4) What do they see when the storm is over?

- A rainbow
- A big ship
- A giant fish
- A treasure chest

Correct answers:

1) Captain Ben 2) Pip 3) Shiny stones 4) A rainbow

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Captain: A person who leads a ship and its crew.

Treasure: Valuable things that are kept safe, like gold or jewels.

Crew: A group of people who work together on a ship.

Adventure: An exciting journey or experience.

Lagoon: A shallow body of water separated from the sea by a reef or sandbank.

Whisper: To speak very softly or quietly.